Ridwan Sharif

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Summary

Experienced with distributed systems, databases, AI/RL systems, sandboxing, infrastructure, performance, and backend engineering; interested in working at high impact teams building scalable tech

Education

University of Waterloo Sept '16 – Apr '21
Bachelors of Computer Science, Honours (with Distinction)

Work Experience

Cursor / SpaceXAI *Canada (Remote)*
Member of Technical Staff June '26 – Present

- Led post-training harness, sandboxing, and scaling infrastructure for Grok 4.5+ model development
- Architected vendor data pipeline for reliable RL training data ingestion and validation at scale
- Developed data quality and evals infrastructure to monitor and improve training signal quality

Google *Toronto, ON*
Senior Software Developer (Cloud Observability) June '21 – June '26

- Tech lead of the managed observability teams, enabling over **$150M+** in ARR
- Enabled metrics collection for Cloud Run, observing **1M+** serverless workloads
- Architected scalable telemetry collection, storage, and routing for GKE, GCE, Cloud Run, etc.
- OSS Core Contributor to OpenTelemetry and Prometheus, multiple time speaker at KubeCon ([1],[2])

Google *Waterloo, ON (Remote)*
Backend Development Intern (gVisor) May – Sep '20

- Expanded the gVisor kernel with Linux compatible sandboxed FUSE filesystems, building the kernel module, device drivers, filesystem syscalls, and protocol implementation

Postmates / Uber *San Francisco, CA & Waterloo, ON*
Platform Development Intern (Delivery as a Service) Jan – Apr '20

- Built the DaaS invoicing, billing, and debt collection system (BigQuery, GCS, Square, Shopify, Stripe), reducing unrecoverable debt by **$50,000+** annually

Cockroach Labs *New York, NY*
Backend Development Intern (SQL Optimizer) May – Aug '19

- Added support for multi-table mutations, ordered aggregations, segmented sort and look-up joins
- Implemented index-skip-scans to improve index scan performance by an order of magnitude

Backend Development Intern (Distributed SQL) Sep – Dec '18

- Designed and implemented load based splitting to replicate and distribute ranges of data across nodes
- Improved overall read/write throughput by over **60%** and **halved** end-to-end latency

Shopify *Ottawa, ON*
Production Development Intern (Infrastructure) Jan – Apr '18

- Led platform observability initiatives; built incident report and cluster health tooling featured on the company engineering blog

Research

uWaterloo Database Systems Group – *Undergraduate Researcher (Prof. Grant Weddell)* 2018

Projects

- **raft, mqueue** – A performant Raft distributed consensus implementation and an in-memory Kafka-esque message broker in Go